

3. What rule of inference is used in each of these arguments?

a) Alice is a mathematics major. Therefore, Alice is either a mathematics major or a computer science major.

Soln: p : Alice is a mathematics major q : Alice is a computer science major.

The form of the argument is: $\frac{p}{p \vee q}$. Rule of inference: Addition

b) Jerry is a mathematics major and a computer science major. Therefore, Jerry is a mathematics major.

Soln: p : Jerry is a mathematics major q : Jerry is a computer science major.

The form of the argument is: $\frac{p \wedge q}{p}$.

Rule of inference: Simplification

c) If it is rainy, then the pool will be closed. It is rainy. Therefore the pool is closed.

Soln: p : It is rainy q : The pool is closed.

The form of the argument is: $\frac{p \rightarrow q \quad p}{q}$ Rule of inference: Modus ponens

d) If it snows today, the university will close. The university is not closed today. Therefore, it did not snow today.

Soln: p : It will snow today q : The university is closed today.

The form of the argument is: $\frac{p \rightarrow q \quad \neg q}{\neg p}$ Rule of inference: Modus tollens

e) If I go swimming, then I will stay in the sun too long. If I stay in the sun too long, then I will sunburn. Therefore, if I go swimming, then I will sunburn.